FOOD REMEDY API

Competitive App Research: FoodIQ [RE006]

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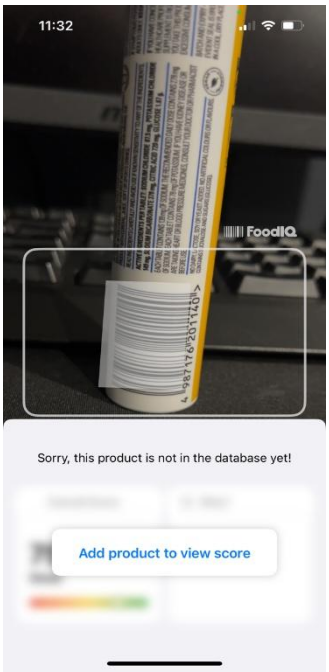
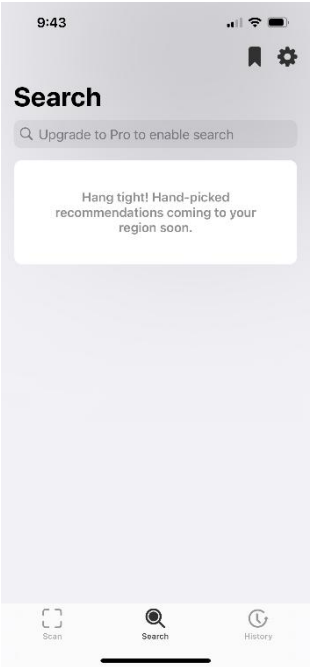
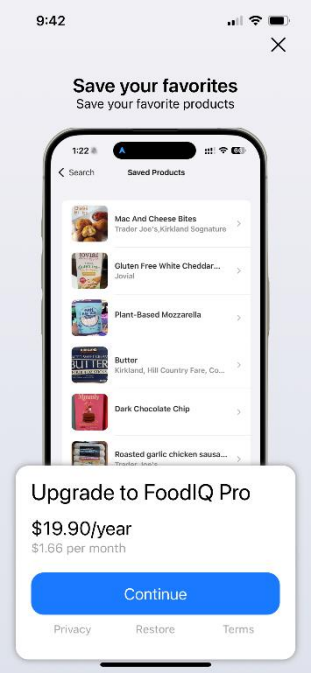
INTRODUCTION

FoodIQ, a free mobile app designed to level-up your grocery shopping experience. Quickly scan the barcode of any food product to receive a detailed health assessment, grounded in the latest scientific research. Learn about ingredients, their safety, and nutritional balance in an easy-to-understand format. Explore healthier options with cleaner ingredients with FoodIQ's carefully curated recommendations.

FEATURES AND FUNCTIONALITY







1. **Functionality**
   - **Speed of Scan:** Users report fast barcode recognition—1–2 seconds under good lighting.
   - **Accuracy:** Barcode detection is generally accurate for mainstream packaged products in the U.S. (Walmart, Target, Whole Foods, etc.) according to some of the reviews on App Store and Internet. The app database still needs to be updated regarding Australian manufactured products.
   - **Offline Use:** Requires internet for most scans since it queries a central ingredient database.

2. Post-Scan Details Displayed

Once a product is scanned, users typically see:

- FoodIQ Score (based on ingredient safety and nutritional value)
- Color-coded risk factors (red = harmful ingredients; green = clean)
- Ingredient list with AI explanations
- Recommended alternatives (if score is low)
- Allergen flags (limited; may miss some)

3. Performance & UX Notes

Factor	Experience
Scan Speed	Fast (1–2 sec typical)
UI Clarity	Clean, modern interface
Load Time	Occasional lags during ingredient analysis
User Control	Can add missing products manually via AI

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR FOOD REMEDY

To enhance its competitive stance, Food Remedy might consider incorporating the following methods derived from FoodIQ's methods:

1. **UI and Educational Enhancements**
    - Add "Did You Know?" tooltips for confusing ingredients.
    - Enable a "compare products" screen post-scan.
    - Provide real-time community feedback per item (e.g., "25 users flagged this as unsafe for gluten").
2. **Expand Ingredient Intelligence**
    - Implement ingredient reasoning transparency: show *why* a food is flagged, using layperson language.
    - Provide cross-referenced health studies behind claims (i.e., link scoring to credible research).
3. **Enhance Scanner Performance**
    - Consider offline scan caching for popular products.
    - Build in voice or camera-based allergen alerts (e.g., speak "contains peanuts" upon scan).
4. **Improve Allergy Profiling**
    - Let users build a custom allergy profile (e.g., gluten-free, nut allergy).
    - Use bold flags or warnings on scanned products based on that profile.

CONCLUSION

FoodIQ offers an efficient and easy-to-use barcode scanner with strong nutritional breakdown, but its allergy detection features are limited and generic. For an app like Food Remedy to surpass it, the focus should shift toward personalisation, deeper allergen intelligence, and medical-grade accuracy—especially for users with strict dietary restrictions.